

Maria-Teresa De Rosa Palmini

PhD Candidate | Digital Society Initiative, University of Zurich

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Research Summary

I work on the evaluation of multimodal generative models, developing benchmarks and evaluation methods to study systematic model behaviours and defaults. My research focuses on cultural knowledge, human values, representation, and bias, with the broader goal of understanding how multimodal AI systems capture, or flatten, the diversity and complexity of cultural and social realities.

Interests: Multimodal Generative Models · Model Evaluation & Benchmarking · Societal Impact of AI · Bias & Fairness

Education

Feb 2024 -	University of Zurich (UZH) PhD, Digital Society Initiative Advisor: Dr. Eva Cetinić Project: The Canon of Latent Spaces: How Large AI Models Encode Art and Culture (SNSF Ambizione)	Zurich, Switzerland
Sep 2021 - Sep 2023	University of Konstanz M.A. Speech and Language Processing (NLP & AI), GPA: 1.3/1.0 (First-Class Honours)	Konstanz, Germany
Sep 2017 - Jun 2021	National and Kapodistrian University of Athens B.A. English Language and Literature (Theoretical & Applied Linguistics), GPA: 8.71/10 (First-Class Honours)	Athens, Greece

Experience

Sep 2026 - Jul 2026	Sony AI Research Intern, AI Ethics Team Manager: Dr. Wiebke Hutiri Project: AI evaluation, benchmarking, and responsible AI	Zurich, Switzerland
Feb 2026 - Apr 2026	Osaka University Visiting Researcher, D3 Center Supervisor: Prof. Dr. Noa Garcia	Osaka, Japan
Sep 2023 - Jan 2024	Intento, Inc. Linguistic Data Analyst, AI Curation Team Prepared linguistic datasets for MT quality improvement; contributed to model evaluation, fine-tuning, and LQA-driven optimisation	Remote
Feb 2022 - Sep 2023	University of Konstanz Graduate Research Assistant Project: CUEPAQ — Visual Analytics and Linguistics for Personalized Argument Quality; impact of semantic, stylistic, and linguistic features on argument quality	Konstanz, Germany

Publications

Instantiation of Human Values in Image Generation

Maria-Teresa De Rosa Palmini, Piera Riccio, Noa Garcia, Eva Cetinić

Conference on Neural Information Processing Systems, Evaluations & Datasets Track

[NeurIPS '26 E&D]

Synthetic History: Evaluating Visual Representations of the Past in Diffusion Models [\[PDF\]](#)

Maria-Teresa De Rosa Palmini, Eva Cetinić

International Conference on Learning Representations

[ICLR '26]

The Persistence of Cultural Memory: Investigating Multimodal Iconicity in Diffusion Models [\[PDF\]](#)

Maria-Teresa De Rosa Palmini, Eva Cetinić

Preprint

[Under Review]

Exploring Language Patterns of Prompts in Text-to-Image Generation and Their Impact on Visual Diversity [\[PDF\]](#)

Maria-Teresa De Rosa Palmini, Eva Cetinić

ACM Conference on Fairness, Accountability, and Transparency

[FAccT '25]

[Oral] Civiverse: A Dataset for Analyzing User Engagement with Open-Source Text-to-Image Models [PDF]

Maria-Teresa De Rosa Palmini, Laura Wagner, Eva Cetinić

European Conference on Computer Vision

[CEGIS @ ECCV '24]

Talks

FAccT 2025	Exploring Language Patterns of Prompts in T2I Generation [video]	Jun 2025
DHCH 2025	Synthetic History, at the <i>Biases in Computer Technology and AI</i> Workshop [program]	2025
CEGIS @ ECCV 2024	Civiverse: User Engagement with Open-Source T2I Models [program]	Sep 2024
Hidden Layers 2024, KISD	Surface Aesthetics: The Secret Formula of Prompting [video]	2024

Academic Service

Co-organizer *From Hype to Reality: AI in the Study of Art and Culture*, University of Zurich (Nov 2025)

Conference Reviewer ICLR '27, NeurIPS '26, ECCV '26

Journal Reviewer Computer Vision and Image Understanding (CVIU)

Teaching and Leadership

Digital Humanities Group, UZH	Community Manager	Jan 2025 – Present
∠ Organise workshops, lectures, and research events across the Digital Humanities community.		
Machine Language Processing (Graduate Course), U. Konstanz	Teaching Assistant	Sep 2022 – Mar 2023
∠ Tutor introducing core NLP concepts to Master's students.		

Graduate Summer Schools

Safe & Trusted AI Summer School	Imperial College London, UK	2025
AI & Creativity Summer School	University of Bologna, Italy	2024

Skills and Languages

Programming Python (advanced), R (intermediate)

ML & Tools PyTorch, Transformers, Scikit-Learn, Hugging Face, Weights & Biases, Git, Linux, Jupyter

Languages Italian, Greek (native); English (C2, Cambridge CPE); French (C1, DALF); Spanish (B2, DELE); German (B1)

References Upon Request

Dr. Eva Cetinić

Senior Researcher (SNSF Ambizione
Fellow)

University of Zurich

Prof. Noa Garcia

Associate Professor

Osaka University

Dr. Wiebke Hutiri

Senior Research Scientist

Sony Research